

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp ***** MONDAY, APRIL 27, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVII NO. 97 WSJ.com ★★★★★ \$5.00

Last week: DJIA 49230.71 ▼ 216.72 0.44% NASDAQ 24836.60 ▲ 1.5% STOXX 600 610.65 ▼ 2.5% 10-YR.TREASURY ▼ 16/32, yield 4.308% OIL \$94.40 ▲ \$11.81 EURO \$1.1722 YEN 159.37

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **A group of budget airlines** including Frontier Group and Avelo Airlines is seeking \$2.5 billion in government assistance in exchange for warrants that could convert into equity stakes in the companies. **B1**
- ◆ **Big American companies** are piling up profits despite war and consumer anxiety, bolstered by healthy sales growth. S&P 500 earnings suggest big U.S. companies are far healthier than wider economic concerns might indicate. **A1**
- ◆ **More Americans** trading in their cars to buy new ones are encountering a difficult reality: Their vehicles aren't worth what they owe. **A1**
- ◆ **China is embracing** styles of passenger vehicles typically associated with the U.S.—the big SUV and brawny pickup truck. **B1**
- ◆ **Amid the threat** from AI tools to software stocks, moves in software-company loans show pockets of strength as Wall Street sorts out winners and losers. **B1**
- ◆ **Hollywood's bet** on a Michael Jackson biopic paid off with an estimated \$217.4 million in worldwide sales in its opening weekend. **B3**
- ◆ **The FTC has reached** an agreement with U.S. Anesthesia Partners to settle charges that it engaged in a scheme to illegally roll up businesses in the Texas market. **B3**
- ◆ **Eni nearly doubled** its share buyback target as conflict in the Middle East pushes prices higher and is expected to give oil majors a cash windfall. **B3**
- ◆ **SLB's quarterly profit** fell amid what its CEO called a challenging start to the year. **B3**

Worldwide

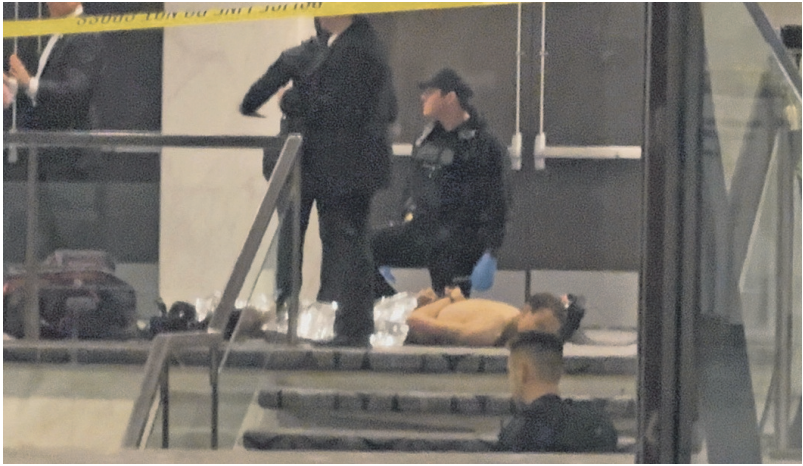
- ◆ **The man accused** of opening fire at the White House correspondents' dinner while Trump was present is a California man who is expected to be charged on Monday. **A1, A4, A5**
- ◆ **The ease with which** the suspect rushed toward the ballroom in Washington raised new questions about Secret Service protocols for protecting the president. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump scrapped a trip** by U.S. envoys to Pakistan for talks with Iran, leaving himself tough choices over how to force Iran to make concessions that the White House wants to strike a deal. **A1**
- ◆ **Sen. Thom Tillis** (R., N.C.) said he would support Kevin Warsh's confirmation, clearing the last significant obstacle to installing Trump's pick to succeed Fed Chair Powell. **A2**
- ◆ **Backers of the proposed** California billionaire tax believe they have gathered enough signatures to get the initiative on the November ballot. **A3**
- ◆ **A Gazan city** held local elections for the first time in more than 20 years in a largely symbolic vote in an enclave long ruled by Hamas. **A7**
- ◆ **Bombings allegedly** perpetrated by a drug-trafficking group in southern Colombia killed at least 20 people, marking the deadliest wave of attacks on civilians in years. **A7**
- ◆ **King Charles III is arriving** in Washington to celebrate 250 years since America ousted his forebears, and privately ensure that the trans-Atlantic relationship can survive Trump. **A7**
- ◆ **Strikes across** Ukraine, Russian-occupied territory and Russia killed at least 16. **A7**

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A Celebration Is Disrupted by Chaos



Clockwise from top left, celebrity mentalist Oz Pearlman was flanked by White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt, Melania Trump and President Trump moments before the shooting Saturday night outside the Washington Hilton ballroom; Secret Service agents on stage after the shooting; Cole Allen, the suspected shooter, being held under custody; House Speaker Mike Johnson being hustled away to safety by agents.

Security Flaw Left President Exposed To D.C. Gunman

At the same hotel where then-President Ronald Reagan was shot 45 years ago, it was remarkably easy for a shooter to charge toward a ballroom where President Trump—along with his cabinet members and the reporters who cover his administration—were dining Saturday night.

By Sadie Gurman, C. Ryan Barber and Isabella Simonetti

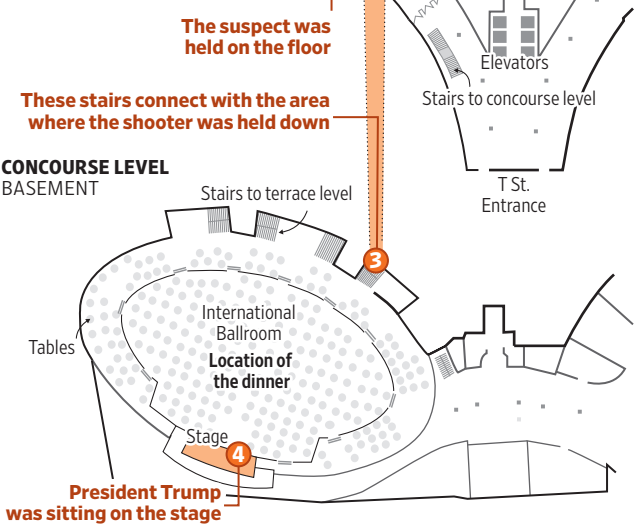
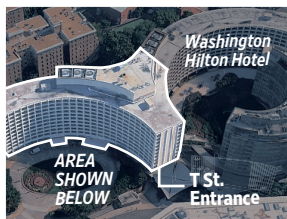
The sprawling Washington Hilton, located about 1½ miles north of the White House, for decades has been home to the White House Correspondents' Association dinner because of its capacity to host a large crowd and the Secret Service's familiarity with securing it.

More than 2,500 people attended the event, including five of the top six officials in the presidential line of succession. Hundreds more gathered for parties that media outlets hosted on site before the main festivities began.

Despite a visible security perimeter and warnings of tight security, guests said they could enter the hotel through checkpoints on the surrounding streets by simply showing a dinner ticket or a copy of an invite to one of several pre-dinner receptions. The tickets were reviewed by staff but weren't scanned and there were no identification checks, attendees said.

"Upon entering nobody asked to visibly INSPECT my

The suspect was detained on the ground floor, near the access to the area where the White House Correspondents' Dinner was taking place.



Note: Plans are schematic. Sources: Wall Street Journal reporters; Google Earth; HCI International BRENNIA SMITH, CARL CHURCHILL, TONIA COWAN, CHIQUI ESTEBAN/WSJ

Shooter storms correspondents' dinner with Trump; 'Are we about to die?'

En route to the White House Correspondents' Association Dinner Saturday evening at the Washington Hilton, President Trump told associates he was excited to deliver his speech, calling it the "hottest ticket in town," a person familiar with the matter said. He and his ad-

By Alex Leary, Josh Dawsey and Natalie Andrews

visers had packed his prepared remarks with jokes, including jabs at members of his own cabinet.

Instead of taking the mic as planned, Trump would be whisked offstage by U.S. Secret Service agents after shots rang out near the cavernous ballroom. What was meant to be an evening of celebration devolved

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◆ **Suspect called brainy and 'a little weird'..... A4**

Pandemic Car Bubble Is Trapping Buyers In Debt

By RYAN FELTON

Doug Horner has seen plenty of customers walk into his northeast Ohio Mercedes-Benz dealership who owe more on their trade-ins than those cars are worth. But being \$40,000 underwater on a pickup truck is a scary sign of a growing trend.

A prospective buyer recently sought to trade in a Ford F-150 Lightning for a Mercedes GLE Coupe, but that potential customer owed about \$87,000 on the pickup truck. Horner estimates the Ford pickup truck was worth about \$47,000—leaving the buyer well underwater.

"This is a battle that we're fighting every day," Horner said in an interview.

More Americans turning in their cars to buy new ones are encountering a difficult reality: Their vehicles aren't worth what they owe.

About 30% of borrowers in the first quarter who traded in a car to buy a new one had negative equity, whereby they owe more on their loan than their car is worth, according to car-shopping website Edmunds. Those borrowers owed about \$7,200 on average before

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R1-26

Aborted Pakistan Trip Leaves Trump Tough Choices on Iran

ISLAMABAD, Pakistan—President Trump scrapped a trip by U.S. envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner to Pakistan for talks with Iran, leaving himself tough choices

By Benoit Faucon, Laurence Norman and Natalie Andrews

over how to force Tehran to make concessions the White House wants to strike a deal.

Trump said Iran can reach out to the U.S. if it wants to negotiate an end to the conflict. "They can call us," he told Fox News on Sunday, adding any talks would be con-

ducted by phone. He then left for St. Petersburg, where he will meet with Russian President Vladimir Putin.

Late Saturday, Trump said a shooting at the White House Correspondents' Association dinner in Washington wouldn't deter him from winning the war with Iran.

Earlier in the day, he said he had decided to cancel the trip by his envoys because an offer from Iran had fallen short of the White House's expectations, adding that U.S. officials had received a better one shortly after canceling the trip.

"We're not going to spend 15 hours in airplanes all the

time, going back and forth, to be given a document that was not good enough," he said.

Witkoff and Kushner had been expected to travel to Islamabad for a potential meeting with Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi, but U.S. and Iranian officials said the two sides remain far apart on issues such as the U.S. blockade, the closure of the Strait of Hormuz and Tehran's nuclear program.

The deadlock over talks

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◆ **Pope's remarks put just-war theory to test..... A7**
◆ **How energy crisis is spreading across world... A7**

San Francisco Is Going Nuts Over a Giant Sea Lion

'Chonkers' captivates locals with his massive frame and disregard for his dockmates' space

By ROBERT MCMILLAN

San Francisco is not only on the rebound, she is in love. His name is Chonkers. He is a 2,000-pound Steller sea lion who swam up to a dock on Pier 39 a month ago and has decided to stay.

The city noticed immediately. Chonkers is about three times the size of the California sea lions that typically

inhabit the San Francisco Bay, and when he crashes his mighty frame down on the dock he's chosen to sleep on, it sounds like an oak tree falling down.

Online commenters quickly began tracking his every move.

Soon after he was spotted, a San Francisco—Please turn to page A12



Local celebrity

Big-Company Profits Overcome Headwinds

By THEO FRANCIS

Big American companies are piling up profits despite war and consumer anxiety, bolstered by healthy sales growth.

With just over a quarter of S&P 500 companies reporting results for the first quarter, Wall Street's expectations for earnings suggest big U.S. companies are far healthier than wider economic concerns might indicate.

"Earnings growth has been exceptional," said Parag Thatte, an equity strategist for

Deutsche Bank. "We're seeing the broadening of earnings growth beyond just tech and financial" firms.

War in the Middle East had led economists to rein in growth projections for the year. Consumers—long the engine of the U.S. economy—feel solidly in the dumps. High oil prices act like a tax, dragging down household consumption while boosting inflation.

Yet the biggest U.S. public companies are seeing profits and revenue surging. Year—Please turn to page A6